

» WORLD VIEW OF THE FORTNIGHT



« No one is going to catch Max (Verstappen) this season. His driving and the car are just spectacular. Basically, this season is now the best of the rest. Hopefully we catch up to the McLaren and then the Ferraris and fight for P2.

– Toto Wolff, Mercedes team boss »



« You have no idea how hard it is for me to not be able to play at these events. The only thing I can do is accept the situation and try to look at the immediate future. – Rafael Nadal, after pulling out of the Monte Carlo Masters »

0.3s

Ireland basketball team Portlaoise Panthers refused to replay the final 0.3 seconds of its Division One game against Limerick Sport Eagles because it would be “against the spirit” of the sport. Limerick beat Portlaoise 80-78 in the quarterfinal. The Panthers appealed the result on the grounds that a foul call, which led to the Eagles’ winning free throws, was awarded 1.6 seconds after the buzzer. Ireland basketball chiefs ordered the teams to

replay 0.3 seconds of the game. However, the Panthers said in a statement that replaying a fraction of a second in the quarterfinal would go against the “values of the game of basketball.”



1000

The Wuhan Open is back on the women’s tennis schedule for the first time since 2019 after organisers announced it will be staged in the Chinese city in October, *Xinhua News Agency* reported. The 1000 tournament has not featured on the WTA circuit since COVID-19 was discovered in the city. The tournament will be held from October 7 to 13 at the Optics Valley International Tennis Center in Wuhan.

SMASHING ANOTHER RECORD!



Novak Djokovic became the oldest World No. 1 in ATP rankings history, a record previously held by Roger Federer. Serbia’s Djokovic, the most decorated male tennis player in the Open era with 24 Majors, is 36 years and 321 days old. He already holds the record for most weeks (419) spent as the top-ranked male player with second-placed Federer (310 weeks) way behind. Djokovic became World No. 1 on July 4, 2011 at the age of 24. Both of Djokovic’s great ‘Big Three’ rivals, Federer and Rafael Nadal, reached No. 1 for the first time aged 22. AP